

How to use these token cutouts



These pages contain the text *The Tale of Peter Rabbit* by Beatrix Potter. Each **cutout** shows a **next word** paired with the **previous word** that came immediately before it in the original text.

Model vitals	
1123 tokens	2.25 bits/token entropy
4.8 perplexity	2.32 branching factor

Anatomy of a cutout



Every distinct word has its own colour. **Previous** words appear inside a coloured box (the word's own colour as the background, with white text); the free-standing **next word** appears in plain coloured text. The same word always wears the same colour, whether you see it inside a box or free-standing. Two unrelated words can occasionally share a colour, so always verify the word itself matches—not just the colour.

Setup

Cut out the tokens along the dotted lines and **spread them out** face-up on the table, with no overlap if possible. This is the “training” step: every (previous, next) combination from the original text is now a physical cutout sitting on your table.

How to play: the matching game

To generate text, repeatedly find a cutout whose **previous word** matches the last word you've written, then **write its next word** onto your page. The word you just wrote becomes part of what you'll match against next—that's the chain.

Worked example

Step 1. Pick any cutout to begin—say this one—and copy its previous word *and* its next word onto your page.

Step 2. Look at the last word you’ve written (*upon*) and find a cutout whose previous word matches it. Write its next word.

Step 3. Repeat: find a cutout whose previous word matches the last word you’ve written, and add its next word.

Keep going—write as much or as little as you like.

the cutout

Once upon

upon a

a time

your page

Once upon

Once upon a

Once upon a time

Tips

Use colour as a fast filter. Scan by the rightmost previous-word box’s colour first, then verify the actual word matches.

Pick from many candidates by eye. The more cutouts share the same previous word, the more often your eye lands on one—that’s **weighted sampling** for free, and it’s why some words follow others more often in your text.

Put the cutout back after using it—removing it would change the model’s distribution next time round.

Once **Once** upon **upon** a **a** time **time** there
there were **were** four **four** little **little** Rabbits
Rabbits , **,** and **and** their **their** names
names were **were** Flopsy **Flopsy** , **,** Mopsy
Mopsy , **,** Cotton **Cotton** tail **tail** , **,** and
and Peter **Peter** . **.** They **They** lived **lived** with
with their **their** mother **mother** in **in** a **a** sand
sand bank **bank** , **,** underneath **underneath** the
the root **root** of **of** a **a** very **very** big **big** fir
fir tree **tree** . **.** now **now** my **my** dears **dears** ,

, said said old old Mrs Mrs . . rabbit

rabbit one one morning morning , , you

you may may go go into into the the fields

fields or or down down the the lane lane ,

, but but don't don't go go into into Mr Mr .

. McGregor's McGregor's garden garden : : your

your Father Father had had an an accident

accident there there ; ; he he was was put

put in in a a pie pie by by Mrs Mrs .

. McGregor McGregor . . now now run

run along **along** , **,** and **and** don't **don't** get

get into **into** mischief **mischief** . **.** I **I** am

am going **going** out **out** . **.** then **then** old

old Mrs **Mrs** . **.** rabbit **rabbit** took **took** a

a basket **basket** and **and** her **her** umbrella

umbrella , **,** and **and** went **went** through

through the **the** wood **wood** to **to** the

the baker's **baker's** . **.** she **she** bought **bought** a

a loaf **loaf** of **of** brown **brown** bread **bread** and

and five **five** currant **currant** buns **buns** .

. Flopsy Flopsy , Mopsy Mopsy , and
and Cottontail Cottontail , who who were
were good good little little bunnies bunnies ,
, went went down down the the lane lane to
to gather gather blackberries blackberries :
: but but Peter Peter , who who was
was very very naughty naughty , ran
ran straight straight away away to to Mr Mr .
. McGregor's McGregor's garden garden , and
and squeezed squeezed under under the

the gate **gate** ! **!** first **first** he **he** ate **ate** some

some lettuces **lettuces** and **and** some

some French **French** beans **beans** ; **;** and

and then **then** he **he** ate **ate** some

some radishes **radishes** ; **;** and **and** then **then** ,

, feeling **feeling** rather **rather** sick **sick** , **,** he

he went **went** to **to** look **look** for **for** some

some parsley **parsley** . **.** but **but** round

round the **the** end **end** of **of** a **a** cucumber

cucumber frame **frame** , **,** whom **whom** should

should he he meet meet but but Mr Mr .

. McGregor McGregor ! ! Mr Mr . . McGregor

McGregor was was on on his his hands

hands and and knees knees planting

planting out out young young cabbages

cabbages , , but but he he jumped jumped up

up and and ran ran after after Peter Peter ,

, waving waving a a rake rake and and calling

calling out out , , Stop Stop thief thief !

! Peter Peter was was most most dreadfully

dreadfully frightened **frightened** ; ; he

he rushed **rushed** all **all** over **over** the

the garden **garden** , , for **for** he **he** had

had forgotten **forgotten** the **the** way **way** back

back to **to** the **the** gate **gate** . . he **he** lost

lost one **one** of **of** his **his** shoes **shoes** among

among the **the** cabbages **cabbages** , , and

and the **the** other **other** shoe **shoe** amongst

amongst the **the** potatoes **potatoes** . . after

after losing **losing** them **them** , , he **he** ran

ran on on four four legs legs and and went

went faster faster , , so so that that I I think

think he he might might have have got

got away away altogether altogether if if he

he had had not not unfortunately

unfortunately run run into into a a gooseberry

gooseberry net net , , and and got got caught

caught by by the the large large buttons

buttons on on his his jacket jacket . . it

it was was a a blue blue jacket jacket with

with brass **brass** buttons **buttons** , , quite

quite new **new** . . Peter **Peter** gave

gave himself **himself** up **up** for **for** lost **lost** ,

, and **and** shed **shed** big **big** tears **tears** ; ; but

but his **his** sobs **sobs** were **were** overheard

overheard by **by** some **some** friendly

friendly sparrows **sparrows** , , who **who** flew

flew to **to** him **him** in **in** great

great excitement **excitement** , , and

and implored **implored** him **him** to **to** exert

exert himself **himself** . **Mr** **Mr** . **McGregor**

McGregor came **came** up **up** with **with** a

a sieve **sieve** , **which** **which** he **he** intended

intended to **to** pop **pop** upon **upon** the **the** top

top of **of** Peter **Peter** ; **but** **but** Peter

Peter wriggled **wriggled** out **out** just **just** in

in time **time** , **leaving** **leaving** his **his** jacket

jacket behind **behind** him **him** . **and**

and rushed **rushed** into **into** the **the** tool

tool shed **shed** , **and** **and** jumped

jumped into **into** a **a** can **can** . **.** it **it** would

would have **have** been **been** a **a** beautiful

beautiful thing **thing** to **to** hide **hide** in **in** ,

, if **if** it **it** had **had** not **not** had **had** so

so much **much** water **water** in **in** it **it** . **.** Mr

Mr . **.** McGregor **McGregor** was **was** quite

quite sure **sure** that **that** Peter **Peter** was

was somewhere **somewhere** in **in** the **the** tool

tool shed **shed** , **,** perhaps **perhaps** hidden

hidden underneath **underneath** a **a** flower

flower pot pot . he he began began to
to turn turn them them over over carefully
carefully , , looking looking under under each
each . . presently presently Peter Peter sneezed
sneezed Kertyschoo Kertyschoo ! ! Mr Mr .
. McGregor McGregor was was after after him
him in in no no time time . . and and tried
tried to to put put his his foot foot upon
upon Peter Peter , , who who jumped
jumped out out of of a a window window ,

, upsetting **upsetting** three **three** plants **plants** .

. the **the** window **window** was **was** too

too small **small** for **for** Mr **Mr** . **McGregor**

McGregor , , and **and** he **he** was **was** tired

tired of **of** running **running** after **after** Peter

Peter . **he** **he** went **went** back **back** to **to** his

his work **work** . **Peter** **Peter** sat **sat** down

down to **to** rest **rest** ; **he** **he** was **was** out

out of **of** breath **breath** and **and** trembling

trembling with **with** fright **fright** , , and

and he he had had not not the the least

least idea idea which which way way to to go

go . . Also Also he he was was very

very damp damp with with sitting sitting in

in that that can can . . after after a a time

time he he began began to to wander

wander about about , , going going lippity

lippity lippity lippity not not very very fast

fast , , and and looking looking all all round

round . . he he found found a a door door in

in a a wall wall ; ; but but it it was

was locked locked , , and and there there was

was no no room room for for a a fat fat little

little rabbit rabbit to to squeeze

squeeze underneath underneath . . an an old

old mouse mouse was was running running in

in and and out out over over the the stone

stone doorstep doorstep , , carrying

carrying peas peas and and beans beans to

to her her family family in in the the wood

wood . Peter Peter asked asked her her the
the way way to to the the gate gate , , but
but she she had had such such a a large
large pea pea in in her her mouth mouth that
that she she could could not not answer
answer . she she only only shook shook her
her head head at at him him . Peter
Peter began began to to cry cry . then
then he he tried tried to to find find his
his way way straight straight across across the

the garden **garden** , **,** but **but** he **he** became

became more **more** and **and** more

more puzzled **puzzled** . **.** presently **presently** ,

, he **he** came **came** to **to** a **a** pond **pond** where

where Mr **Mr** . **.** McGregor **McGregor** filled

filled his **his** water **water** cans **cans** . **.** a

a white **white** cat **cat** was **was** staring

staring at **at** some **some** gold **gold** fish **fish** ,

, she **she** sat **sat** very **very** , **,** very **very** still

still , **,** but **but** now **now** and **and** then

then the **the** tip **tip** of **of** her **her** tail

tail twitched **twitched** as **as** if **if** it **it** were

were alive **alive** . **.** Peter **Peter** thought

thought it **it** best **best** to **to** go **go** away

away without **without** speaking **speaking** to

to her **her** ; **;** he **he** had **had** heard

heard about **about** cats **cats** from **from** his

his cousin **cousin** , **,** little **little** Benjamin

Benjamin Bunny **Bunny** . **.** he **he** went

went back **back** towards **towards** the **the** tool

tool shed **shed** , **but** **but** suddenly **suddenly** ,

quite **quite** **close** **close** to **to** him **him** , **he**

he heard **heard** the **the** noise **noise** of **of** a

a hoe **hoe** scr **scr** r **r** ritch **ritch** , **scratch**

scratch , **scratch** **scratch** , **scritch** **scritch** .

Peter **Peter** scuttered **scuttered** underneath

underneath the **the** bushes **bushes** . **but**

but presently **presently** , **as** **as** nothing

nothing happened **happened** , **he** **he** came

came out **out** , **and** **and** climbed

climbed upon **upon** a **a** wheelbarrow

wheelbarrow and **and** peeped **peeped** over

over . **.** the **the** first **first** thing **thing** he

he saw **saw** was **was** Mr **Mr** . **.** McGregor

McGregor hoeing **hoeing** onions **onions** . **.** his

his back **back** was **was** turned **turned** towards

towards Peter **Peter** , **,** and **and** beyond

beyond him **him** was **was** the **the** gate **gate** !

! Peter **Peter** got **got** down **down** very

very quietly **quietly** off **off** the **the** wheelbarrow

wheelbarrow ; ; and **and** started

started running **running** as **as** fast **fast** as

as he **he** could **could** go **go** , , along **along** a

a straight **straight** walk **walk** behind

behind some **some** black **black** currant

currant bushes **bushes** . . Mr **Mr** . . McGregor

McGregor caught **caught** sight **sight** of **of** him

him at **at** the **the** corner **corner** , , but

but Peter **Peter** did **did** not **not** care **care** .

. he **he** slipped **slipped** underneath

underneath the **the** gate **gate** , **,** and **and** was

was safe **safe** at **at** last **last** in **in** the **the** wood

wood outside **outside** the **the** garden **garden** .

. Mr **Mr** . **.** McGregor **McGregor** hung **hung** up

up the **the** little **little** jacket **jacket** and

and the **the** shoes **shoes** for **for** a **a** scare

scare crow **crow** to **to** frighten **frighten** the

the blackbirds **blackbirds** . **.** Peter **Peter** never

never stopped **stopped** running **running** or

or looked **looked** behind **behind** him **him** till

till he he got got home home to to the
the big big fir fir tree tree . he he was
was so so tired tired that that he he flopped
flopped down down upon upon the the nice
nice soft soft sand sand on on the the floor
floor of of the the rabbit rabbit hole hole and
and shut shut his his eyes eyes . his
his mother mother was was busy busy cooking
cooking ; ; she she wondered wondered what
what he he had had done done with with his

his clothes clothes . it it was was the
the second second little little jacket jacket and
and pair pair of of shoes shoes that that Peter
Peter had had lost lost in in a a fortnight
fortnight ! ! I I am am sorry sorry to to say
say that that Peter Peter was was not not very
very well well during during the the evening
evening . . his his mother mother put put him
him to to bed bed , , and and made
made some some camomile camomile tea tea ;

; and and she she gave gave a a dose dose of
of it it to to Peter Peter ! ! one one table
table spoonful spoonful to to be be taken
taken at at bed bed time time . . but
but Flopsy Flopsy , , Mopsy Mopsy , , and
and Cotton Cotton tail tail had had bread
bread and and milk milk and and blackberries
blackberries for for supper supper .